

Remote Work Policy

Category: Remote Work | Effective: January 2025 | Version 1.0

The Remote Work Policy establishes a framework for eligible employees to perform their duties from home or other remote locations, ensuring that such arrangements align with the company's operational needs, employee performance standards, and applicable provisions under Lebanese Labour Law. This policy is designed to provide flexibility while maintaining accountability, productivity, and compliance with legal and organizational requirements.

Eligibility Criteria

Remote work arrangements are not an automatic right and will be granted at the discretion of management. Eligibility is determined based on the following criteria:

- Job Requirements:** The role must be suitable for remote execution without compromising the quality of work or team collaboration. Positions that require a high degree of in-person interaction, such as those in facilities management or on-site IT support, may not qualify for remote work.
- Employee Performance:** Employees must have demonstrated a consistent level of productivity, reliability, and accountability in their current role. Employees on Performance Improvement Plans (PIPs) or those with documented instances of misconduct may not be eligible.
- Operational Feasibility:** Management will evaluate the impact of remote work on team dynamics, communication, and overall business operations before approving any arrangement.
- Trial Period:** New employees must complete a mandatory probation period of three months before becoming eligible for remote work, unless otherwise specified in their employment contract.

Procedure to Request Remote Work

- Submission of Request:** Employees must submit a formal written request for remote work to their immediate supervisor, outlining the reasons for the request and how they will meet job expectations while working remotely.
- Manager Review:** Supervisors will assess the request against the eligibility criteria and discuss it with the employee to address any concerns or clarify expectations.
- Approval Process:** Approved requests will be escalated to the department head and the HR department for final confirmation. Employees will be notified of the decision within five business days of submitting their request.
- Remote Work Agreement:** Employees whose requests are approved must sign a Remote Work Agreement, which outlines their obligations, including but not limited to:
 - Defined working hours.
 - Availability for communication during working hours.
 - Productivity and performance expectations.
 - Data security and confidentiality requirements.

Employee Responsibilities

- Work Environment:** Remote employees must establish and maintain a professional and distraction-free work environment. This includes having an ergonomic workspace and ensuring minimal disruptions during working hours.
- Data Security:** Employees are required to adhere to company IT policies, including the secure use of company-issued devices, strong password management, and compliance with data protection regulations under Lebanese law.
- Resources:** Unless explicitly agreed otherwise, employees are responsible for ensuring adequate internet connectivity and other necessary resources to perform their tasks effectively.
- Communication:** Employees must remain reachable via email, phone, or other designated communication platforms during agreed working hours. Participation in virtual meetings, as scheduled by the company, is mandatory.

Employer Responsibilities

- Provision of Equipment:** The company may provide essential equipment (e.g., laptops, software licenses) for remote work, subject to an inventory agreement signed by the employee.
- Performance Monitoring:** Supervisors are responsible for monitoring the performance of remote employees and providing regular feedback. Performance reviews will include an evaluation of remote work outcomes, such as meeting deadlines, maintaining productivity, and contributing to team goals.

3. Support and Training: The company will offer training sessions on remote work best practices and the use of digital communication tools to ensure employees are well-equipped for remote work.

Timelines for Remote Work Arrangements

1. Approved remote work arrangements may be temporary or long-term, depending on the nature of the request and business needs. The duration of the arrangement will be specified in the Remote Work Agreement.
2. Temporary arrangements will be reviewed after an initial trial period of three months, with the possibility of extension based on performance and operational impact.
3. Long-term arrangements will be reviewed annually as part of the employee's performance evaluation.

Exceptions and Special Circumstances

1. Emergency Remote Work: In cases of emergencies (e.g., natural disasters, pandemics, or political unrest), management may impose mandatory remote work for all eligible employees. In such instances, the company will provide additional support and guidance to ensure business continuity.
2. Medical Accommodation: Employees requiring remote work as a reasonable accommodation for medical reasons must provide a valid medical certificate. Such requests will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis in accordance with Lebanese Labour Law and company policies.
3. Employee Relocation: Employees wishing to work remotely from a different country or jurisdiction must obtain prior approval from management and HR. Such arrangements will be subject to local employment laws, tax implications, and the company's operational capacity to support cross-border remote work.

Termination or Modification of Remote Work Arrangements

1. The company reserves the right to modify or terminate remote work arrangements if they negatively impact performance, team collaboration, or overall business operations. Employees will be provided with a minimum of 14 days' notice before any such change, except in cases of misconduct or urgent business needs.
2. Employees may request to terminate their remote work arrangement and return to on-site work by providing written notice to their supervisor at least 14 days in advance.

Compliance and Disciplinary Measures

1. Employees found to be in breach of the Remote Work Agreement, including but not limited to instances of data breaches, misuse of company equipment, or non-compliance with working hours, may face disciplinary action in accordance with the company's Code of Conduct and Lebanese Labour Law.
2. Regular audits may be conducted to ensure compliance with the policy, including the proper use of company-provided equipment and adherence to performance standards.

This policy serves to foster a flexible and productive work environment while safeguarding the company's operational integrity and ensuring compliance with Lebanese Labour Law.